Lullberry

Digital Detox

21 practices and ideas from the best books on digital detox

Week 1

1 Start where you are

Spend today simply observing your digital habits without judgment. What do you reach for? When and why?

"Principle #1: Clutter is costly." Cal Newport, Digital Minimalism

2 Define your why

Get clear on your reasons for doing this detox. Before opening any app today, ask: 'What am I seeking?' and 'When will I know I'm done?'

"This is your life—what do you want to pay attention to?" Catherine Price, How to Break Up with Your Phone

3 Audit your digital life

List your most-used apps, sites and platforms. For each, ask: does this nourish me or drain me?

"When you pay attention to something you don't especially value, it's not an exaggeration to say that you're paying with your life." Oliver Burkeman, Four Thousand Weeks

4 The notification purge

Silence non-essential notifications, especially social media, shopping and news.

"The art of being wise is the art of knowing what to overlook." W. James in Oliver Burkeman, Meditations for Mortals

5 Curate your feed

Unfollow accounts that trigger comparison or anxiety. Follow only what uplifts or teaches you.

"Your smartphone is mostly just other people's agenda for you." Emma Seppälä, Sovereign

6 Set screen-free zones

Designate at least one space in your home (like the dining table or bedroom) as tech-free. Move your charging spot outside your bedroom to discourage late-night scrolling and morning phone checks.

"Fill the center of your life... with things that reward creativity, relationship, and engagement." Andy Crouch, The Tech-Wise Family

7 Gratitude pause

Before checking social media, write down 3 things you're grateful for in your real life.

"Reconnect with a part of you that knows that life doesn't happen on a screen." Catherine Price, How to Break Up with Your Phone

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Week 2

8 Design a mindful morning

Craft a screen-free morning ritual: meditation, stretching, journaling, or just slow tea.

"When we know what to say no to, we can say yes to the things that matter." Ryan Holiday, Stillness Is the Key

9 Single-task your screens

Use one device for one task at a time. Close the other tabs and let your attention rest in one place.

"Our goal isn't abstinence; it's consciousness." Catherine Price, How to Break Up with Your Phone

10 Batch your digital tasks

Check email, social media and messages only at set times, for example twice a day.

"In a world of distraction, focusing is a superpower." Ryan Holiday, Discipline Is Destiny

11 Unplugged mealtimes

Commit to at least one meal a day completely free of digital devices.

"Checking your phone is like picking your nose: there's nothing wrong with it, but no one should have to watch you do it." Catherine Price, How to Break Up with Your Phone

12 Leave your phone behind

Go somewhere today without your phone: a walk, a café, an errand. Notice how you feel.

"Simply put, humans are not wired to be constantly wired." Cal Newport, Digital Minimalism

13 Evening digital sunset

Turn off all screens 1 to 2 hours before bed. Use this time to stretch, read, or prepare for the next day.

"We wake up before our devices do, and they 'go to bed' before we do." Andy Crouch, The Tech-Wise Family

14 Tech Shabbat

Try a half-day digital sabbath. No screens unless essential: immerse yourself in real life.

"A day without the sensory food of e-mail, videos, books, and conversations is a chance to clear our mind." Thich Nhat Hanh, Silence

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Week 3

15 Get creative

Find creative replacements: swap Instagram for sketching, news apps for journaling, TikTok for tea and a book.

"There is nourishment in pursuits that have no purpose—that is their purpose." Ryan Holiday, Stillness Is the Key

16 Replace, don't just remove

Try analog tools for tasks you usually do on a screen. Rediscover the joy of a paper notebook.

"The heart of our home is built around things older and better than the newest thing." Andy Crouch, The Tech-Wise Family

17 Reconnect in real life

Make a call instead of texting. Meet someone in person. Let human connection replace screen time today.

"The socializing that counts is real conversation, and text is no longer a sufficient alternative." Cal Newport, Digital Minimalism

18 Relearn boredom

Notice when you reach for your phone out of boredom. Sit with the urge for a few minutes and see if it passes.

"In Zen they say: If something is boring after two minutes, try it for four... Eventually one discovers that it is not boring at all." J. Cage in Jenny Odell, How to Do Nothing

19 Weekend detox challenge

Try a device-free stretch from Friday evening to Saturday noon. Let this time hold space for real life.

"The world is like muddy water. To see through it, we have to let things settle." Ryan Holiday, Stillness Is the Key

20 Craft your digital code

Write your personal tech manifesto: based on the last 3 weeks, what boundaries and habits will support your values from now on?

"Build a life that you don't need to escape from." Ryan Holiday, Stillness Is the Key

21 Notice what's changed

Compare today to day 1. Notice what has shifted over these three weeks, and set your own terms for the slip-ups ahead.

"What unplugging lets us do is reflect on the past, present, and future." Tiffany Shlain, 24/6

Make it your practice

Feel, do or reflect: find the practices that fit you.

Week 1	Feel	Do	Reflect
1 Start where you are	After scrolling, notice: do you feel energized or drained? Name one feeling. For one day, notice how you feel just before and just after each time you pick up your phone.	For one hour, count your phone pickups. Just count, no judgment. Each evening for a week, check your screen-time report and note your top 3 apps.	What made you reach for your phone today: boredom, stress, habit? Write the first answer that comes. For 3 evenings, journal about one pickup: what were you feeling just before?
2 Define your why	Hold your phone for a moment before unlocking it. Feel the pull, then decide. Each morning this week, close your eyes and picture a calmer day with less screen time. How does it feel?	Before opening an app, pause and say out loud what you hope to get from it. Record a short voice note on why you're doing this detox. Replay it when your motivation dips.	Write down your top 3 reasons for this detox. Circle the one that matters most. Write one clear goal, for example: 'I'll cut screen time by 2 hours a day to make room for hobbies.' Review it every Sunday.
3 Audit your digital life	Notice which apps leave you tense and which leave you calm. Name the feeling. For 3 days, rate each app from −5 (draining) to +5 (nourishing) by how you feel after using it.	List your top 5 apps and delete one you don't really need. Move every draining app off your home screen into one folder, and leave it there for a week.	Ask of your most-used app: would I download it again today? Write your answer and why. Over a week, journal about the platform you use most: what does it give you, and what does it cost you?
4 The notification purge	Turn off one non-essential alert and notice how you feel: relief, or a little anxiety? Keep your phone on silent for 3 days. Each evening, notice how calm or restless you felt.	Turn off lock-screen previews, so messages wait until you choose to look. Turn on Do Not Disturb for one full afternoon and notice what you get done.	Which notification pulls you away most often? Write down what it really needs from you. For a week, jot down each alert that interrupted something important. Then decide which ones deserve to stay.
5 Curate your feed	Scroll your feed for one minute and notice where jealousy or irritation shows up in your body. For a week, notice how each app leaves you feeling, and follow five accounts that bring you calm or creativity.	Spend 10 minutes unfollowing accounts on Instagram or YouTube that no longer serve you. Hide your main feed for a week with a feed blocker, and visit only the accounts you choose.	Which content fits your values, and which doesn't? Write one line for each. Write your own short content rule: what earns a place in your feed, and why?
6 Set screen-free zones	Sit in bed without your phone one night and notice how it feels. Keep your phone out of the bedroom for a week and note changes in your sleep and mood.	Move your charger from your nightstand to the hallway. Make a visible tech-free sign or basket for your dining table.	List the spaces at home that could use screen-free rules. Write your own house rule: 'No screens in [room], because it's a space for…'
7 Gratitude pause	Name one thing you're grateful for before you open social media. For a week, pause before each scroll and savor one good moment from your day for 30 seconds.	Write one thing you're grateful for on a sticky note and put it on your phone. For a week, write 3 good things in a notebook before your first scroll of the day.	Does comparing yourself online dim your gratitude? Write about one recent moment. For 7 days, log your gratitude and your screen time side by side. What do you notice?

Make it your practice

Week 2	Feel	Do	Reflect
8 Design a mindful morning	Start one day with 5 minutes of silence or tea before looking at your phone. For a week, notice how your mood feels on mornings you don't check your phone first.	Use a real alarm clock and leave your phone in another room overnight. Plan a simple 3-step morning routine and follow it for 3 days.	What do you want to feel first thing in the morning? Write it down. Describe your ideal morning in one page. Which part could you start this week?
9 Single-task your screens	Watch one video with full attention, no tab-switching. Work for one focused hour, phone in another room and one tab open, and notice how your mind settles.	Write one message from start to finish without opening another app. For a week, use a focus app or timer to block other apps during your main task.	When did you last do just one thing at a time? Write a few lines about how it went. For 5 days, jot down one task you did single-mindedly and how it compared to multitasking.
10 Batch your digital tasks	Check messages only after lunch and after dinner today, and notice the quiet in between. Set two tech windows a day for a week and notice how your focus shifts.	Write your two check-in times on a sticky note and put it on your screen. For a week, group your online chores (banking, shopping, bills) into one weekly session.	Which messages truly need a fast reply? Write down the few that do. After a week of batching, journal: what did you gain, and what, if anything, did you miss?
11 Unplugged mealtimes	Eat one meal today with your phone out of sight. Savor the first three bites. Make a tech-free dinner your daily ritual for a week, even when eating alone. Light a candle.	Put a small basket by the table where phones rest during meals. Invite others to a screen-free lunch and talk about how it feels.	What do you miss when you eat with a screen? Write one sentence. Write three rules for mindful meals and try them for a week.
12 Leave your phone behind	Walk to the corner store without your phone and notice the sounds around you. Spend two hours outdoors without any digital devices.	Go to a café with a book or journal instead of your phone. Take a weekend hike without GPS, using a printed map.	How did you feel without your phone: anxious, free, or both? Write it down. Write a page that begins: 'When I'm away from my phone, I discover…'
13 Evening digital sunset	Switch off all screens an hour before bed and notice how your eyes and mind feel as you read a paper book. Build a calming 90-minute pre-bed routine with music, stretching and journaling, and keep it for a week.	Set a screen cutoff alarm and put your devices in another room. For a week, use your screen-free hour to lay out tomorrow's clothes and plan your day on paper.	What do you usually reach for a screen for at night? Write down what else could meet that need. For 2 weeks, keep a sleep journal comparing nights with and without screens.
14 Tech Shabbat	Put away screens for a Saturday morning and take a mindful walk. From Friday dinner to Saturday lunch, unplug and notice what you miss and what you gain.	Set out analog fun (books, puzzles, cards) and invite your family to join. Host a phone-free picnic or board game gathering.	Read a little about Shabbat. What could a weekly day of rest bring to your life? Write your own ritual plan: what you'll do during a half-day tech break.

Make it your practice

Week 3	Feel	Do	Reflect
15 Get creative	Next time you reach to scroll, doodle for 5 minutes instead. Notice how your hand and mind feel. For a week, replace evening scrolling with journaling, sketching or watercolor.	Take a 20-minute photo walk with a real camera, or your phone in airplane mode. Sign up for an offline creative class: pottery, improv or painting.	What did you love making as a child? Write down one thing you could try again. For a week, journal about how making things by hand changes your sense of time.
16 Replace, don't just remove	Use a paper to-do list today instead of an app, and enjoy crossing things off. Switch your calendar, journal and notes to paper for a week, and notice how it feels.	Buy a small notebook and carry it for notes, ideas and reminders. For two weeks, swap one screen habit for an analog one: a wristwatch, a paper map or a cookbook.	Which task feels better on paper than on a screen? Write down why. After a week, make a pros and cons list of the paper tools you've tried.
17 Reconnect in real life	Call a friend instead of texting, and listen closely to their voice. Meet someone for a screen-free coffee and share how you're both feeling.	Greet a neighbor or coworker face-to-face today. For a week, replace one text conversation a day with a call or a visit.	Who do you text most but rarely see? Write down one way to meet them. For a week, journal about your in-person moments: which ones left you feeling most alive?
18 Relearn boredom	Sit on a bench for 10 minutes without reaching for anything. Just notice. Once a day for a week, wait in line without your phone and feel the urge rise and fall.	Next time you feel bored, do one small chore by hand instead of picking up your phone. Spend a day without headphones and do ordinary tasks with full presence.	What are you avoiding when you reach for your phone out of boredom? Write it down. For a week, keep a notebook nearby and jot down the ideas that come when you do nothing.
19 Weekend detox challenge	Spend Friday night device-free: light candles or take a bath instead. Extend your detox until Saturday noon and notice how your mind shifts.	Put all your devices in a box and enjoy analog fun for one evening. Take a nature walk, garden or visit a museum, all without devices.	Write down what feels hardest about being offline. After the detox, write about what you missed and what you didn't, and what that says about your habits.
20 Craft your digital code	Choose 3 words you want your tech use to reflect, such as calm, depth or connection. Read your 3 words aloud each morning for a week and notice how they guide your choices.	Stick a note near your desk with one intention: 'I use tech to create, not to escape.' Write and decorate a personal contract with your digital boundaries and commitments.	Which screen habits fit your life goals, and which don't? Write one of each. Imagine yourself a year from now with healthy tech habits. Write a letter describing a typical day.
21 Notice what's changed	Notice one feeling that's different from day 1, maybe calmer or lighter. Name it. Each evening this week, take a quiet minute to feel what the detox has given you.	Reread your day 1 notes and jot down what's different now. Put your day 20 contract where you'll see it daily, and set a monthly check-in.	Name one slip-up you expect ahead, and decide now it won't mean starting over. Write your restart rule for lapses: no guilt, just the next pickup done differently.